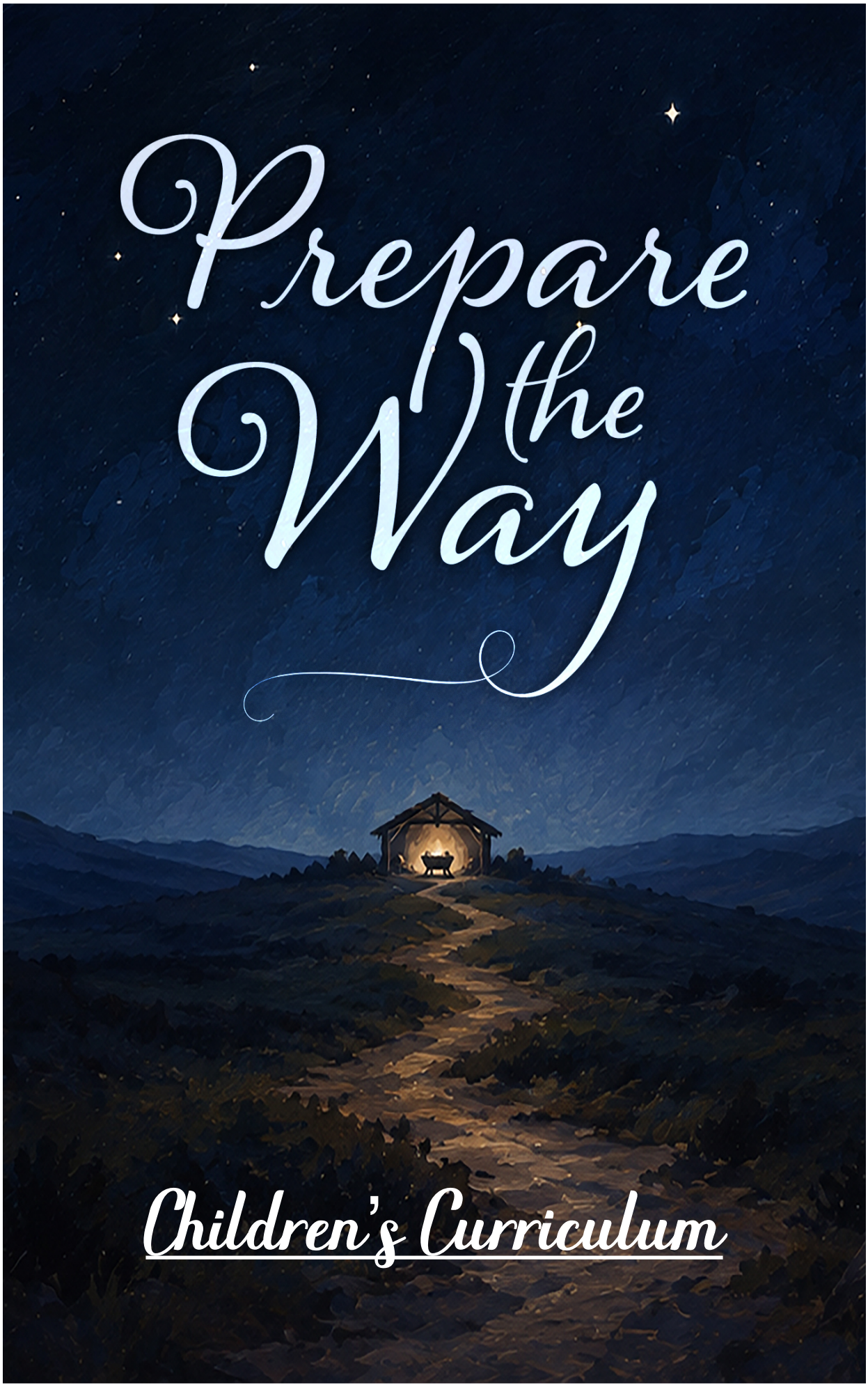

Prepare the Way
Children's Curriculum

Prepare the Way
Advent Children's Curriculum

Overall Theme
God is preparing the way for Jesus, and we prepare our hearts to receive Him.

Series Memory Verse
"Prepare the way for the Lord." — Isaiah 40:3

Series Goal
Throughout Advent, children will discover that God's people waited and hoped for God's coming. Through Isaiah's words, they will learn that God comes near, brings comfort, restores what is broken, shines light into darkness, and ultimately brings joy through Jesus.

The Five-Week Journey

Week	Passage	Theme	Symbol	Big Idea
Advent 1	Isaiah 64:1–9	God, Come Near!	Empty manger	We can ask God to come near.
Advent 2	Isaiah 40:1–11	God Is With Us	Blanket	God comes to comfort His people.
Advent 3	Is. 61:1–4, 8–11	Good News for All	Gift	God brings good news to those who are hurting.
Advent 4	Isaiah 9:1–7	Jesus Is Our Light	Candle/light	Jesus brings light into darkness.
Christmas	Isaiah 61:10–62:3	Celebrate!	Wrapped gift	God's salvation gives us joy.

The Progression

The series can build around five simple words that children can easily remember:

COME → COMFORT → GOOD NEWS → LIGHT → JOY

Or, even more simply:

We wait.
We hope.
We prepare.
We welcome.
We celebrate.

Week 1 — Prepare the Way for God to Come

Isaiah 64:1–9

Big Idea: We can ask God to come near.

Children's Theme: God, Come Near!

Key Verse:

"Oh, that you would tear open the heavens and come down!" — Isaiah 64:1

Lesson Focus

Isaiah begins Advent with a bold prayer: "God, come!" God's people recognize that they need Him and long for His presence.

Help children understand that Advent isn't simply about waiting for Christmas—it is about waiting for God and making room for Him in our lives.

Creative Teaching Image

An empty manger

Show the children an empty manger and explain:

"Right now, the manger is empty. Advent is a season of waiting. We are preparing the way for Jesus."

Children's Response

Have children write or draw something they want to invite God into —their family, friendships, school, fears, etc.

Place their responses around an empty manger.

Take-Home Challenge

Make Room for God: Each day this week, spend one quiet minute saying: "God, come near. Help me make room for You."

Week 2 — Prepare the Way with Comfort

Isaiah 40:1–11

Big Idea: God comes to comfort His people.

Children's Theme: God Is With Us

Key Verse:

"Comfort, comfort my people, says your God." — Isaiah 40:1

Lesson Focus

God's people had experienced difficulty and disappointment, but Isaiah announces that God has not forgotten them.

Advent reminds us that God comes into our world to bring comfort and hope.

Creative Teaching Image

A blanket: Wrap a child or volunteer in a blanket and talk about what it feels like to be warm and safe.

Then explain: "A blanket doesn't make every problem disappear. But it reminds us that we aren't alone. Isaiah tells God's people that God comes near to comfort them."

Children's Response

Create a "Comfort Chain."

Each child receives a paper strip and writes one way they can bring comfort to someone this week.

Connect the strips into a chain and display it.

Take-Home Challenge

Be a Comforter: Do one intentional act of kindness for someone who needs encouragement.

Week 3 — Prepare the Way with Good News

Isaiah 61:1–4, 8–11

Big Idea: God sends good news to people who are hurting.

Children's Theme: Good News for Everyone

Key Verse:

“The Spirit of the Sovereign Lord is on me.” — Isaiah 61:1

Lesson Focus

Isaiah describes God's servant bringing good news, freedom, healing, and hope .

Connect this passage with Jesus' ministry. Jesus comes not simply to be celebrated at Christmas but to bring God's good news to people who need it.

Creative Teaching Image

A wrapped gift

Bring out a beautifully wrapped present.

Ask:

* What makes something “good news”?
* Who do you want to tell when something exciting happens?
* What if the best gift wasn't something we could buy?

Explain that Jesus is God's good news to the world.

Children's Response

Create Good News Cards for people who might need encouragement.

Children can write:

"God loves you."
"You are not forgotten."
"Jesus is with you."
"There is hope."

Take-Home Challenge

Share the Good News: Encourage one person this week with words that point them toward God's love.

Week 4 — Prepare the Way for the Light

Isaiah 9:1–7

Big Idea: Jesus brings light into darkness.

Children's Theme: Jesus Is Our Light

Key Verse:

"The people walking in darkness have seen a great light." — Isaiah 9:2

Lesson Focus

Isaiah speaks to people experiencing darkness and promises that a great light will come.

Connect Isaiah's promise to the birth of Jesus.

Christmas is approaching, and the light is about to shine.

Creative Teaching Image

Darkness and light

Turn off the room lights and light a single candle or flashlight.

Ask:

"How much light does it take to change a dark room?"

One small light can make a tremendous difference.

Explain:

"Isaiah promised that God's light would come into the darkness. Christians believe that light is ultimately revealed in Jesus."

Children's Response

Give every child a small battery-powered candle or paper candle.

Invite them to name someone who needs God's light and pray:

“Jesus, shine Your light in _____'s life.”

Take-Home Challenge

Be a Light: Look for one opportunity each day to bring kindness, hope, or encouragement to someone else.

Christmas Sunday — Prepare the Way for Joy

Isaiah 61:10–62:3

Big Idea: God's salvation gives us joy.

Children's Theme: Celebrate What God Has Done!

Key Verse:

"I will greatly rejoice in the Lord." — Isaiah 61:10

Lesson Focus

After four weeks of waiting, Christmas arrives!

Isaiah moves from longing and waiting to rejoicing
. God's people celebrate because God has acted.

This gives you a wonderful opportunity to connect the entire Advent journey:

We waited.
We hoped.
We listened.
We watched.
And now we celebrate!

Creative Teaching Image

The Christmas gift

Place a beautifully wrapped gift in the center of the room.

Talk about how anticipation builds when we know something wonderful is coming.

Then connect the gift with God's greatest gift:

"At Christmas, we celebrate that God didn't stay far away. God came near. Jesus was born."

Children's Response

Have children create a “Joy Garland.”

Each child completes the sentence:

“I am joyful because God…”

Examples:

* loves me
* sent Jesus
* forgives me
* is with me
* gives me hope

Connect their responses into a Christmas garland.

Take-Home Challenge

Share the Joy: Find someone who needs joy this Christmas and intentionally share God's love with them.